This code runs in all browsers, and does one of the following:

- If the browser has an `XMLHttpRequest` object and it supports CORS, it returns a new `XMLHttpRequest` object.
- If the browser supports `XDomainRequest`, it returns a new `XDomainRequest` object.
- If the browser doesn't support either of those objects, it doesn't support CORS. It returns `null` to indicate that CORS isn't supported.

While the `XDomainRequest` object looks similar to its `XMLHttpRequest` object, there are many differences between the two. The next section takes a closer look at these differences.

2.4.1 Differences between XDomainRequest and XMLHttpRequest

Although the `XDomainRequest` and `XMLHttpRequest` objects let you make cross-origin requests, there are many differences between the two objects. The `XDomainRequest` object is very limited in the types of cross-origin requests it can make. Table 2.5 compares and contrasts the `XMLHttpRequest` object to the `XDomainRequest` object.

Table 2.5 Comparison of `XMLHttpRequest` and `XDomainRequest`

Supported feature	`XMLHttpRequest`	`XDomainRequest`
HTTP methods	All	`GET` `POST`
HTTP schemes	All	`HTTP` `HTTPS`
Request content type	All	`text/plain`
Synchronous requests	Yes	No
Custom request headers	Yes	No
User credentials (such as cookies)	Yes	No

Event handlers	`onloadstart`
	`onload`
	`onerror`
	`onabort`
	`ontimeout`
	`onprogress`
	`onreadystatechange`
	`onloadend`
		`onload`
		`onerror`
		`ontimeout`
		`onprogress`

Response properties	`status`
	`statusText`
	`responseType`
	`response`
	`responseText`
	`responseXML`
	`getResponseHeader`
	`getAllResponseHeaders`
		`responseText`
		`contentType`